REBUTTAL TESTIMONY OF JARED RODRIGUEZ

Q. Would the witness please state his name and business address?

A. Jared Rodriguez and my business address is 40 West 57th Street, Floor 23, New York, New York 10019.

Q. Are you the same Jared Rodriguez who filed Direct Testimony on behalf of Estates NY in this National Grid Rate Case?

A. Yes.

Q. For what reasons are you filing Rebuttal Testimony in this case?

A, I believe that it is important that the Commission, in this rate case, fully take into consideration the many viable opportunities to improve the long-term energy future of New York State in this proceeding. Specifically, Estates believes that the Future of Heat Panel has laid out three particular strategies/programs with significant merit that could economically and effectively lower GHG emissions across the service territory.

Q. What are these three programs?

A. Expanded Gas Demand Response ("DR"), creation of a renewable natural gas ("RNG") tariff - "Green Gas Tariff" - and development and expansion of the geothermal shared loop program – the Geothermal Demonstration Project. Each of these programs has the potential to lower GHG emissions, provide economic benefits to the Company's customer and more efficiently utilize the Company's current plant in service. I detailed the reasons for our support of these programs in my initial testimony. I would like to add that

the Commission should endeavor to have its goals and directives substantially align with the long range plans of New York State. In that regard, it is very important for the Commission to give the Company the tools necessary to decarbonize and shift to low-carbon business models like shared loop geothermal, otherwise the objectives of the Climate Leadership and Community Protection Act of 2019 will not be met.

Q, Upon review of the direct testimony of the other participants in this case what were the major points of agreement that you could find?

A. I was happy to see that Staff, in the Prepared Direct Testimony of the Staff Efficiency and Sustainability Panel ("DT E&S Panel") in Cases 19-G-0309 & 19-G-0310 (Pgs. 40-48) and the Staff Policy Panel ("DT Policy Panel") (Pg. 26, Lines 6-8) regarding the expansion of Companies' two DR programs, support the Company's proposals in principle for Demand Response.

Q. What concerns do you have regarding such Staff testimony?

A. I am concerned that, while the Staff supports the above two DR programs in principle, Staff did not fully support them by allowing the expenses for the necessary FTE's to support these DR programs to be collected in rates (DT E&S Panel Pg. 48, Lines 1-4, 14-16).

Q. Did you also have concerns regarding Staff's testimony regarding the proposed expanded Geothermal Demonstration Project?

A. Yes. In its testimony, Staff expresses a negative view towards the Geothermal Demonstration Project and neither supports that project nor the addition of a proposed incremental FTE (DT E&S Panel Pg. 52, Lines 18-24; DT Policy Panel, Pg., 25, Lines 15-19 and Pg. 26, Lines 11-13).

Q We believe that a failure to fully staff or support these programs in the rates to be implemented in this rate case will cause these program to be expanded too slowly or not at all at a time when New York State needs clear and decisive action with regard to rapid decarbonization as well as reliable natural gas deliverability right now.

Q. Would you like to elaborate on the concerns you have expressed?

A. Yes, as to my concern that Staff's direct testimony was not supportive of National Grid's proposal on the development of geothermal shared loops, this technology is viable right now and has been demonstrated across the country as well as in New York City. We need to further develop new business models to meet our GHG goals as a state. The current reliance solely on electrification via air-source heat pumps is myopic and we should be pursuing all forms of thermal energy to reduce our reliance on fossil fuels to heat our homes and businesses. To accomplish the worthy goal of bringing this technology to the fore, we can see no better partner than National Grid, the Company with the most experience of delivering thermal energy underground.

Q. Should the Company be granted regulated monopoly status with regard to implementing geothermal shared loop systems?

A. Yes. When geothermal loops are shared by separate private entities for the purpose of accessing remote thermal "sinks or sources" like geothermal well fields or industrial waste heat, and when these shared loops are located in public rights of way, the Company should function as a regulated monopoly in a similar fashion to its natural gas delivery regulated monopoly status. Granting a shared loop thermal energy business model to the Company provides a number of significant benefits to the service territory and to the people of New York State. These benefits include but are not limited to: (1) acceleration of the electrification of heat; (2) reduction of risk to the Company and to rate payers related to the acquisition of stranded assets in the form of natural gas infrastructure; (3) radical reduction of financial, regulatory and logistical barriers to end-user owners of geothermal heating and cooling systems; and (4) provides a platform for market transmission and the development of new economic activities by private sector actors as thermal energy providers. These concepts expand on my previous testimony as it relates to the development of a regulatory framework for thermal energy within the context of New York State's Renewing the Energy Vision. Over the medium and long-term, granting regulated monopoly status to the Company for the purpose of developing and maintaining shared thermal energy infrastructure (i.e. geothermal shared loops)

is the most logical next step in decarbonizing energy for the benefit of the environment.

Q. Does that conclude your testimony?

A. Yes.